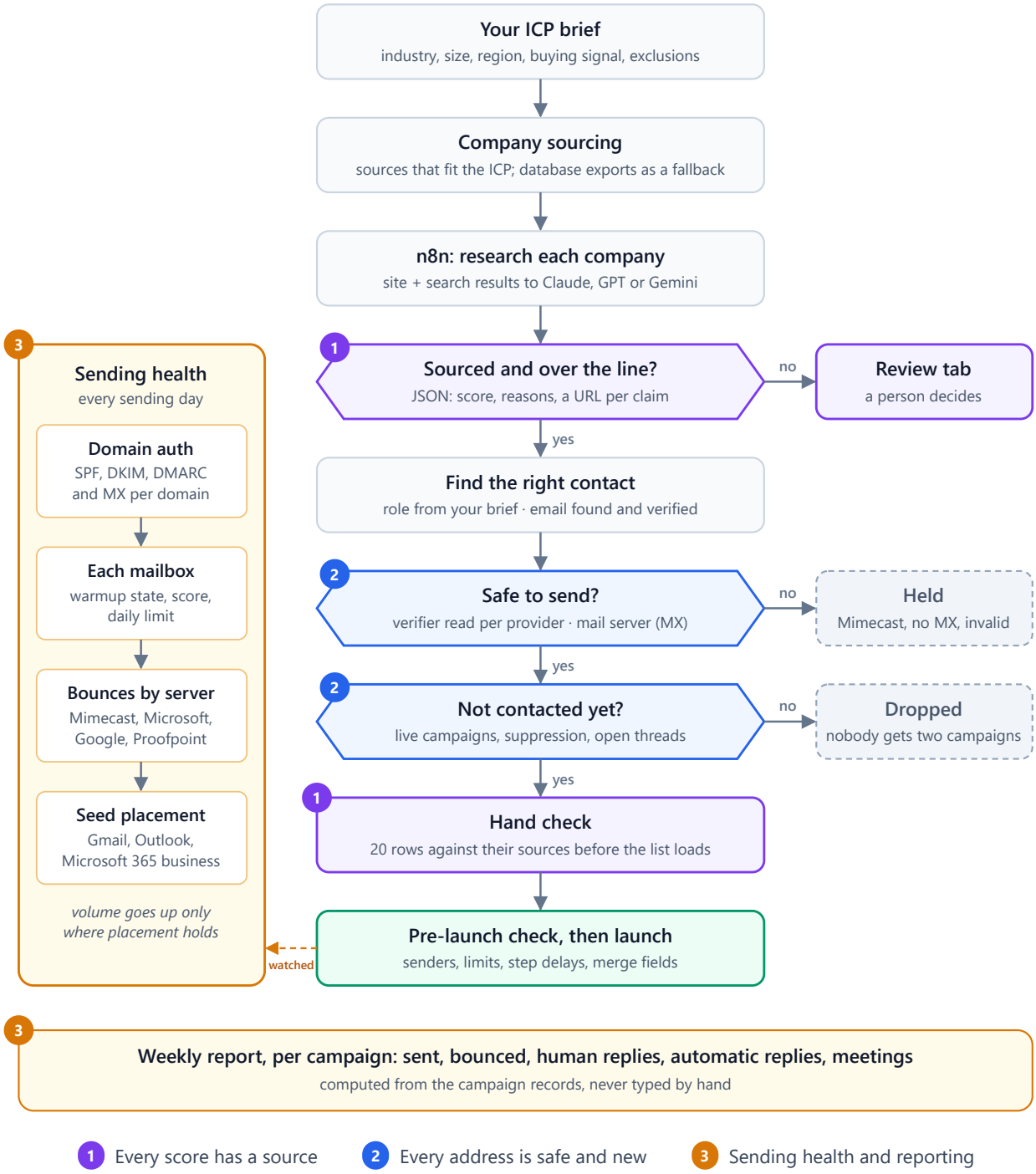
# From ICP brief to launched campaign, with a check at each place a list usually goes wrong

Prepared for Assivo · Matthias, UnpauseAI · 4 November 2026

The four ICP lists each week run through one n8n workflow. The model does the company research; nothing reaches Instantly without a source behind its score, an address that is safe to send to, and a dedupe against every live campaign. The senders are watched every day the lists are sending.



### 1 Every score has a source

- The model gets your ICP brief, the company's site and search results, and returns JSON: a fit score, the reasons, and a source URL for each claim.
- Output that fails the schema, cites nothing, or scores under the line goes to a review tab, not the list.
- Before a list loads, 20 rows are checked by hand against their sources. Where my read and the model's disagree, the prompt changes before the list ships.

### 2 Every address is safe and new

- A verifier checks that a mailbox exists, not that its mail server accepts cold mail. NeverBounce-valid addresses behind Mimecast bounced 10 times in 11 sends; behind Microsoft, once in 80.
- The reverse holds too: "unknown" on Hotmail, iCloud and NHS is the server refusing the probe. All 335 such addresses we could check had already received mail, so they stay.
- Each domain's mail server is read at load; Mimecast and no-MX addresses are held. Dedupe runs against every live campaign, the suppression list and open threads.

## Week 1: the audit

| Check | What it catches |
|---|---|
| SPF, DKIM, DMARC and MX on every sending domain | Domains that can't authenticate or receive replies. In one audit of 53 purchased domains, none had MX records and 3 had SPF and DKIM. |
| Warmup, daily limit and bounces per mailbox, grouped by recipient mail server | Senders that dropped out of the warmup pool (three mailboxes on a domain missing from DNS), and gateway blocks a list verifier can't see. |
| Seed-inbox placement on Gmail, Outlook and Microsoft 365 business | Inbox or spam per provider, before volume goes up. |
| Step delays and merge fields in every live sequence | Instantly puts the delay on the earlier step; a 0 there sends the follow-up minutes after the first email. |
| Report figures recomputed from the campaign records | Hand-typed numbers. One report said 34 people in conversation; the database said 40. |

## Four weeks, $350 a week

| Week | Deliverability ($140) | Data operations ($210) |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Audit and findings list, fixes in order | Research workflow built on your first ICP briefs; the week's lists go through it |
| 2 | Fixes applied, seed tests repeated, daily sender checks | Four ICP lists through the workflow |
| 3 | Pre-launch check on every campaign; volume up only where placement holds | Four lists; scoring adjusted from week 2's replies |
| 4 | Monitoring and a written runbook for the ongoing weeks | Four lists; workflow documented for the ongoing weeks |
| | **Total, fixed price** | **$1,400** |

## Built before (charts in the attached outbound-case-study.pdf)

- **UK events company, Instantly since May:** three sending domains on Google Workspace. Corporate bounce rate went 8.6%, then 1.5%, then 0% over three waves; a 773-person re-engagement bounced 0.6%.
- **Treasury-software company:** a lead desk that replaced nine scattered sources, each contact's stage computed from an event log and a daily mailbox scan. Conference follow-up: 127 reached, 40 in conversation, 20 meetings booked.
- **Finance team:** Gemini and OpenAI in a production receipt pipeline. The model proposes, a person confirms, and nothing it guessed reaches the books.